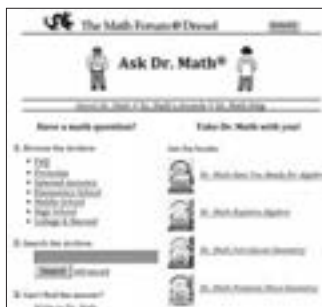


6.3 The Math Forum @ Drexel

www.mathforum.org/dr.math/

An introduction to The Math Forum is provided right on the site: In 1994, the Math Forum discovered a dormant project called “Ask Prof. Maths,” where K-12 students could send in math questions and get personal answers. The folks at Drexel University decided to revive the program, using Swarthmore College math students as “Math Doctors”—students who loved to answer questions from other students.



The Math Forum: indispensable!

By 1995, the rapidly increasing volume of questions required that new members of the staff be recruited from other colleges around the US. By the year 2000, there had been over 300 volunteer “Doctors” from all corners of the globe. The service has received a number of Internet awards.

Students submit questions to Dr. Math by filling out a Web form. Answers are sent back by e-mail, and the best questions and answers are gathered into a searchable archive organised by grade level (elementary, middle school, high school) and topic (exponents, infinity, polynomials, etc.). The Forum recommends using the Dr. Math searcher to find what you want (try keywords like Fibonacci, fractal, or proof), and investigating the Dr. Math FAQ (topics include prime numbers, pi, the golden ratio, Pascal’s triangle).

The scope of the site really is too much to go into here. Every maths problem seems to have been covered! For starters, you can ask away and get your solution e-mailed to you, like we said. Then, you can search the forum in its entirety to find an answer to your question. We typed in “integral pi,” and got “FAQ” answers ranging from “Analytic Geometry: Cylindrical Coordinates” to “Ellipse and